

Churn nearly doubled. It wasn't one cause — it was three, stacked.

How I separated the acute trigger from the amplifier from the pre-existing drain —
and ruled out the obvious suspect.

Fictional SVOD streaming service • synthetic data • real methodology

2x

gross monthly churn, starting month 34 of 36 — and still elevated.

Leadership needed a root cause before the next board meeting: was it content, price, acquisition quality, billing, the app, or the market?

Test every plausible cause — market, price, app, acquisition, payments — and rule out what isn't it.

PRIMARY METRIC

Gross monthly churn %, decomposed by market / cohort / device / tier

METHOD

Every result computed twice — SQL and pandas — and asserted equal

Ten questions, dual-track, parity-checked.

36

MONTHS

3

MARKETS

~70K

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DuckDB SQL and pandas, independently, from market decomposition to an explicit “payments ruled out” finding.

3

overlapping causes, none sufficient alone

A connected-TV app regression (the acute trigger), a Brazil price hike (the amplifier — engaged subscribers untouched), and a Mexico cohort-quality drag (the pre-existing drain).

Payments were the obvious suspect. They were tested first — and ruled out.

Failure rate, dunning recovery, and involuntary churn are all flat. Whatever changed, it wasn't billing.

Fix the app regression first — it's the acute trigger. The other two need slower fixes.

Full methodology, numbers, and code — link in my Featured section.